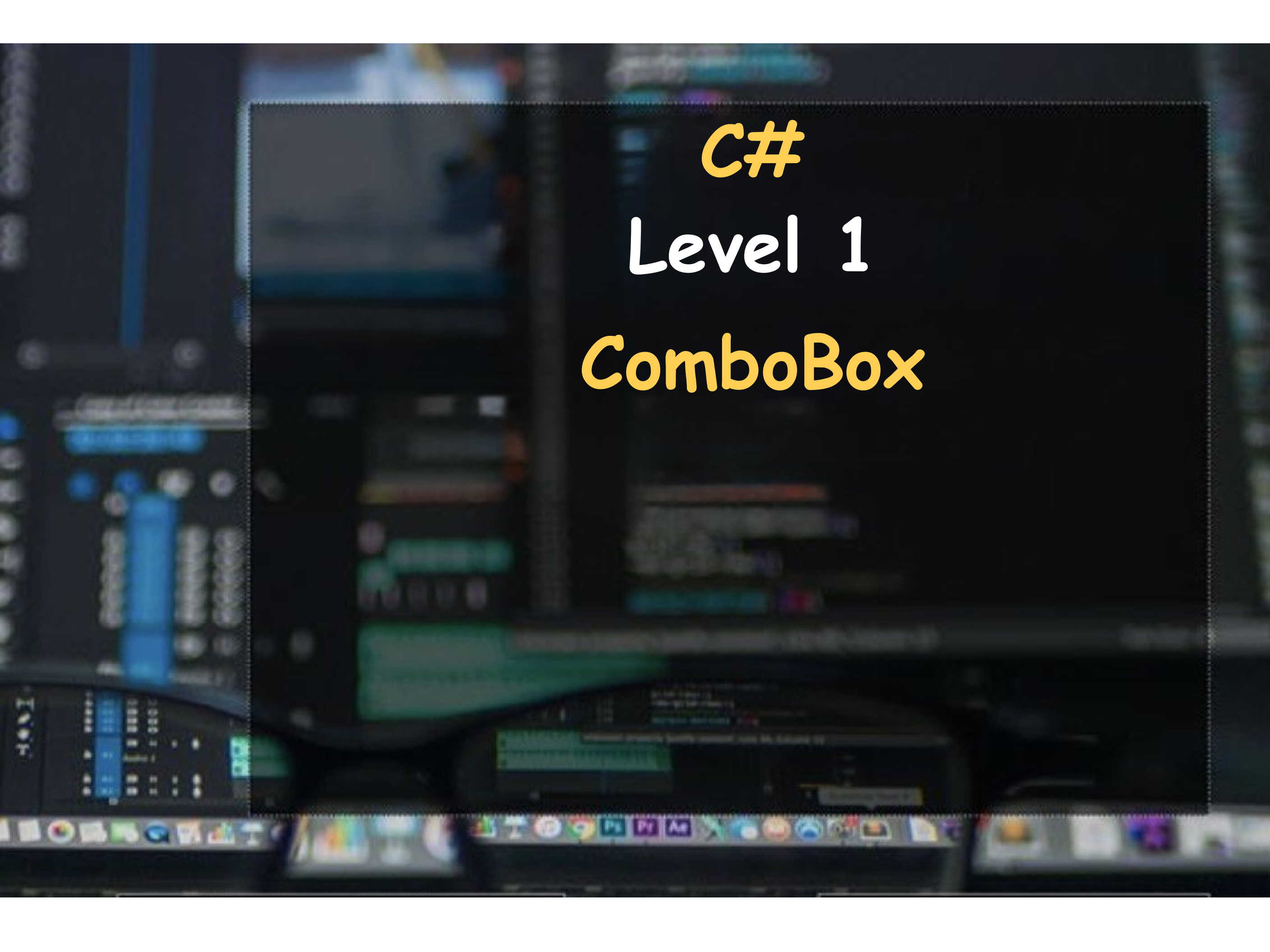




C#

Level 1

ComboBox



C#

Level 1

ComboBox

Definition

ComboBox

-  A Windows Forms control that displays a drop-down list of items.
-  The user can select an item and, depending on its configuration, type a value.

Explanation

Items Collection

-  Stores the available items in the ComboBox.

-  Items can be added using `Items.Add()`.

Selection

-  `SelectedItem` returns the currently selected item.

-  `SelectedIndex` returns the index of the selected item.

Selection Event

-  `SelectedIndexChanged` runs when the selected item changes.

Procedure

1. Add a ComboBox to the Windows Form.
2. Add items using `Items.Add()`.
3. Display the drop-down list.
4. Select an item.
5. Get the selected item using `SelectedItem`.
6. Get its position using `SelectedIndex`.
7. Handle changes using `SelectedIndexChanged`.

💡 Example

```
private void Form1_Load(object sender, EventArgs e)
{
    comboBox1.Items.Add("Sweden");
    comboBox1.Items.Add("Saudi Arabia");
    comboBox1.Items.Add("Germany");
}
private void comboBox1_SelectedIndexChanged(object sender, EventArgs e)
{
    MessageBox.Show(comboBox1.SelectedItem.ToString());
}
```

➡ Result

ComboBox:

Sweden

Saudi Arabia

Germany

If the user selects:

Saudi Arabia

MessageBox:

Saudi Arabia

Note

- ◆ SelectedIndex starts from 0.
- ◆ First item → index 0.
- ◆ Second item → index 1.
- ◆ If no item is selected, SelectedIndex is usually -1.
- ◆ DropDownStyle controls whether the user can type into the ComboBox.
- ◆ Text gets or sets the displayed text.



Comparison



ComboBox

- ✓ Displays items in a drop-down list.
- ✓ Allows the user to select an item.
- ✓ Uses `SelectedItem` and `SelectedIndex`.



ListBox

- ✓ Displays items directly in a list.
- ✓ Does not use a drop-down list.
- ✓ Can support multiple selections.

⊘ Warning

- ◆ SelectedItem can be null when no item is selected.
- ◆ Calling SelectedItem.ToString() without checking can cause a `NullReferenceException`.
- ◆ Duplicate items are allowed.

✦ Summary

- ✓ ComboBox provides a drop-down list for selecting values.
 - ▣ Items → stores the available items.
 - ▣ Items.Add() → adds an item.
 - ▣ SelectedItem → gets the selected item.
 - ▣ SelectedIndex → gets its index.
 - ▣ SelectedIndexChanged → detects selection changes.
 - ▣ Text → gets or sets the displayed text.
 - ▣ DropDownStyle → controls the input behavior.

Thank you 😊